

QUESTIONS YOU MIGHT BE ASKED IN JOB INTERVIEWS

You can prepare for job interviews by thinking about the type of questions you may be asked and practising your responses. It also really helpful to use InterviewStream on CareerHub to record and listen to your responses, and then get feedback from the team at the Employability Lab.

Questions about you	Guidelines
1. Tell me about yourself. 2. How would a relative/ former employer describe you? 3. What are your strengths/weaknesses? 4. Where do you see yourself in five years' time? 5. Tell me about your long term career goals? 6. What frustrates you? How do you cope with frustration? 7. How do you work under pressure? 8. How do you manage to meet deadlines? 9. Have you ever had more than one thing to do at the same time? How did you handle it?	1/2. Show you have self-awareness—a critical skill that not everyone possesses. 3. A job description will help you focus on your strengths and weaknesses in relation to the tasks listed. 4/5. Provide evidence of whether or not you are the sort of person who plans ahead. 4/5. Discuss training or promotion opportunities and give some idea of long-term career plans. 6-9. Give examples of situations you have been in that you have handled positively. Remember there is no correct answer. The employer is more interested in whether you have developed strategies rather than in what these strategies are.
Questions about your education	Guidelines
10. What extracurricular activities were you involved in? Which of them did you enjoy the most? Why? 11. What was the most important thing you learned studying? 12. Describe your most rewarding tertiary experience. 13. Why did you choose your programme/specialisation? 14. What papers did you like the best/least? Why? 15. What did your programme cover? How do you think it is relevant to this job? 16. If you could, how would you plan your academic study differently? Why? 17. What are your plans for education in the future?	10/11. University environments provide lots of opportunity. Demonstrate that you have used your opportunities to learn and develop, whether your experience was positive and successful or not. 12/13. The interviewer is looking for the same capabilities and behaviour in your university (or previous job) life that they want in the job. 13/14. Show evidence of knowledge, positive attitude towards study and an understanding of skills and knowledge you have gained. 15-17. Planning and organising is one of the keys to good work at any level so it's essential to acknowledge this.
Questions about your employment experiences	Guidelines
18. Describe previous work experience you really enjoyed/disliked and explain what you liked/disliked about it. 19. In previous work experiences, did you initiate any new procedures, systems, or activities? 20. Describe your ideal work environment. 21. Tell me about a time you experienced a problem in your work environment and how you dealt with it? 22. Can you recall a time when your performance at work was criticised? Describe the situation and your response. 23. Why did you leave your last position?	18/20. The interviewer wants to hear how you will fit into the company and whether you can take the initiative. 21/22. Interviewers will learn a lot about your emotional maturity when you are invited to explain or comment about a past 'negative experience'. 21/22. You should be able to talk objectively and honestly about 'negative' experiences, and interpret them into positive experiences. 23. This can be a tricky position if you were fired or stormed out. Whatever you do, don't make negative comments about an employer or organisation. Discuss with a career consultant if you're not sure

Questions About The Position	Guidelines
24. Why are you interested in this position? 25. Why do you want to work for this organisation? 26. Why should I hire you? 27. What do you think it takes to be successful in an organisation like ours? 28. In what ways do you think you can make a contribution to our organisation? 29. What do you wish to accomplish as a... (insert occupation)? 30. If you were hiring a graduate for this position, what qualities would you look for?	24-26. Focus on specific duties outlined in the job description or what your understanding of typical tasks for this kind of job would be. 27/28. Respond with good specific solutions and suggestions in response to stated organisational requirements. 28. You should cover the kinds of skills, interests or knowledge from previous study or work that you would bring to the position. 28-30. Your answers reveal the amount of homework you have done before the interview. Use your initiative to find out as much as you can about the organisation and during the interview cite ways in which you have gone about finding out this information.
Questions about your Motivation, Skills, Knowledge and Experience.	Guidelines
32. What motivates you to do well? 33. When have you been most motivated? 34. What accomplishments have given you the most satisfaction? 35. What skills do you have that you consider will make you successful in performing this role? 36. What experience have you had in ...? 37. Describe your time management and organisational skills. 38. Tell me about a time when you had difficulty (eg communicating with someone). How did you handle it? 39. Tell me about (eg a team project you worked on). What worked well? What were the challenges and how did you cope with them? 40. Tell me about your work in the area of ...?	32-34. The interviewer is trying to understand the key to you being successful in a job. Consider what actually does motivate you and think of some specific examples to share. Your response will vary based on your background and experiences, but, you will want to share your enthusiasm and what you like. 35-37. Relate your strengths and capabilities to the priorities of the job function, and to the aims and priorities of the organisation. 38-40. Demonstrate an understanding of both sides of the question - the needs of the employer, and how to apply your skills, capabilities, experience, style and strengths to the situation. Certain interviewers and situations will also be seeking indications of the candidate's personal style when working with others - notably whether the candidate will be an asset to the team in terms of motivation and morale.
Good questions to ask the Employer	Guidelines
41. How does the role fit into the structure of the department? Organisation? 42. What will the initial training period involve? 43. What would you say is the most challenging aspect of the job? 44. How will my responsibilities and performance be measured? And by whom? How often? 45. Does the organisation support ongoing training and education for employees to stay current in their fields? 46. Are there opportunities for promotion within the organisation? 47. How soon will you decide on the appointment? 48. How did this job become available?	41 - 44. Clearly understand your role and the tasks that you would be expected to undertake. It is easy to make assumptions and get the wrong impression of what the work would be so it is vital for both sides that there is clarity in what is expected of you. 41-46. Understand where the job might lead and what skills you might acquire. It also signals that you are ambitious and thinking ahead. This is a good time to ask the employer what skills they consider to be the most critical for the position, and whether they see a gap in the skills you have to offer. This will give you an opportunity to identify skills and/or experiences which have not yet come up during the interview.